

Japan Chemicals: CCL trade data: Apr-Jun shipment value +41% yoy, positive read-across for Mitsubishi Gas Chemical, Mitsui Kinzoku, others

According to Japan's Ministry of Finance trade statistics for June 2026, shipment volume of CCL (copper-clad laminates) on a volume basis increased +15% yoy, and shipment value rose +46% yoy. Demand thus remained very strong on a value basis. Total shipment value for the Apr-Jun 2026 quarter reached +41% yoy and +12% qoq, which we view as broadly positive for related companies such as Mitsubishi Gas Chemical and Resonac, as well as Mitsui Kinzoku and Nitto Boseki (all Buy-rated).

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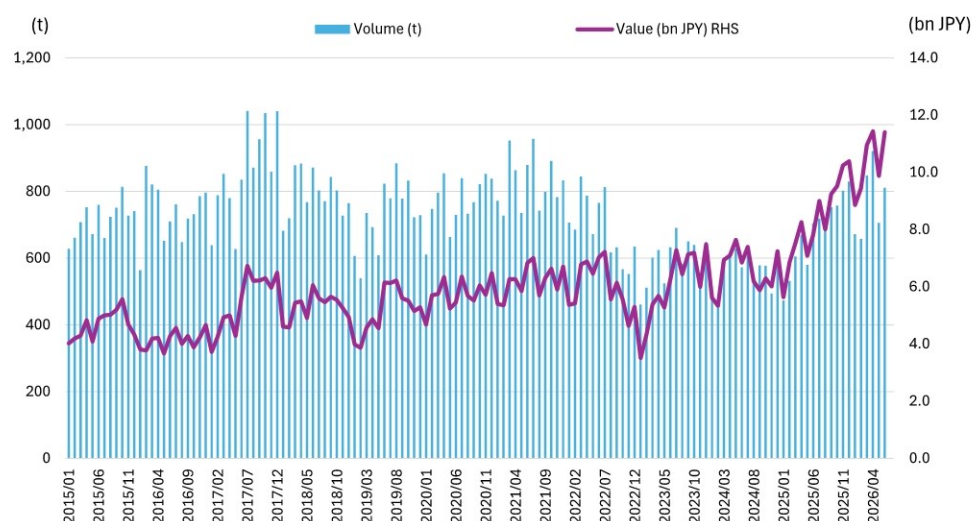
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We assume that data are tracking at a favorable pace relative to guidance (full-year sales growth of +15% for BT materials) at Mitsubishi Gas Chemical, which has the top global market share in BT materials for semiconductor package substrates, and the 1H shipment volume outlook (+20% yoy) for MicroThin™ at Mitsui Kinzoku, which holds a large share in ultra-thin copper foil.

We assume this is driven by the larger size and higher layer counts of package substrates for AI servers (such as NVIDIA's next-generation Rubin GPUs) and strong demand for LPDDR and e-SSDs. We reaffirm our view that CCL price hikes will gain momentum from 2H, and we reiterate our Buy ratings on related companies, including Mitsui Kinzoku, where progress is being made with price increases, and Nitto Boseki, which has a strong presence in T-glass cloth, for which supply/demand is tight.

In June 2026, CCL shipment volume was +15% yoy/+15% mom, and shipment value was +46% yoy/+16% mom, both strong levels. Shipment value for the Apr-Jun 2026 quarter reached ¥32.7 bn, expanding considerably by +41% compared to the same period last year (¥23.2 bn). Even compared to the ¥29.3 bn in the previous quarter (Jan-Mar 2026), this represented +12% qoq growth. Furthermore, we think the resilience of global CCL demand can be further confirmed, considering shipments from Thailand are also likely increasing after Mitsubishi Gas Chemical brought its new Thailand plant online in December 2025 (+50% in total capacity).

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Exhibit 1: Monthly trends in CCL export volume and value

Source: Ministry of Finance, Bloomberg

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Mitsubishi Gas Chemical

We are Buy rated on Mitsubishi Gas Chemical with a 12-month target price of ¥6,890. Our target price is based on the materials sector EV/GCI and FY3/28E CROCI/WACC correlation (sector cash-return multiple of 0.75X plus a 5% premium to the sector average).

Key risks: Stiffer competition in smartphone lens specialty resins and semiconductor package substrate materials, yen appreciation, and price declines for methanol and other market-sensitive products.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Resonac

We are Buy rated on Resonac with a 12-month target price of ¥23,920. Our target price is based on the correlation between the materials sector's EV/GCI and the FY12/27E CROCI/WACC (cash-return multiple of 0.7X plus a 30% premium to the sector average). Key risks include a slowdown in semiconductor demand, yen appreciation, and decline in graphite electrode earnings.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Mitsui Kinzoku

We are Buy rated on Mitsui Kinzoku with a 12-month target price of ¥62,600. Our target price is based on the correlation between the materials sector's EV/GCI and our FY3/28E CROCI/WACC forecast (cash return multiple of 0.7X plus a 60% premium to the sector average). Key risks include slowdown in AI server demand, yen appreciation, and decline in prices for zinc and other metals.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Nitto Boseki

We are Buy rated on Nitto Boseki with a 12-month target price of ¥4,820. Our target price is based on the correlation between the materials sector's EV/GCI and the FY3/28E CROCI/WACC forecast (cash-return multiple of 0.7x plus a 60% premium to the sector average). Key risks include fluctuations in semiconductor demand, currency volatility, and changes in the competitive landscape for specialty glass.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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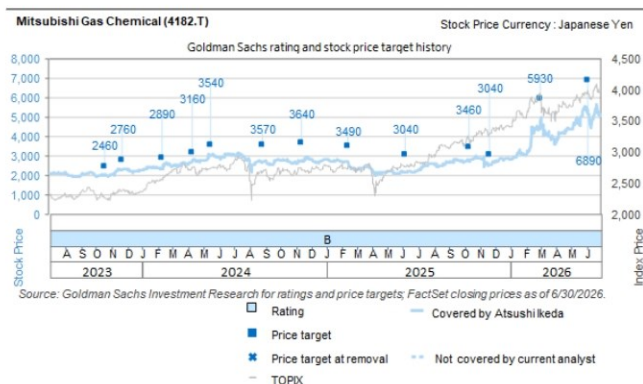
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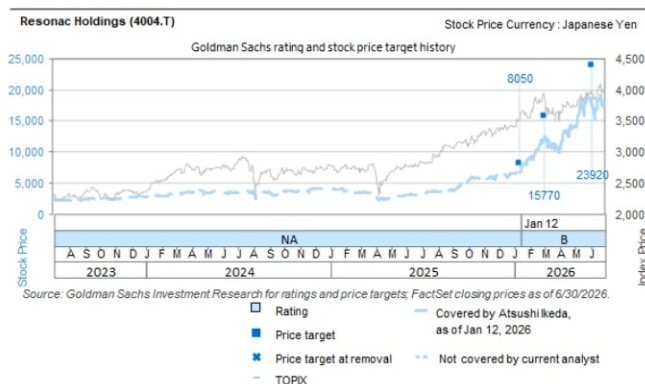
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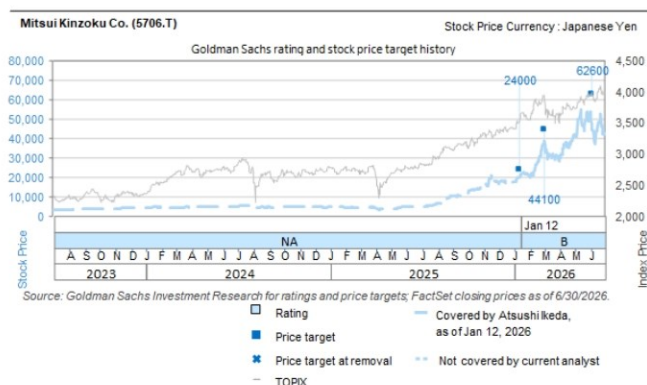
Price target and rating history chart(s)



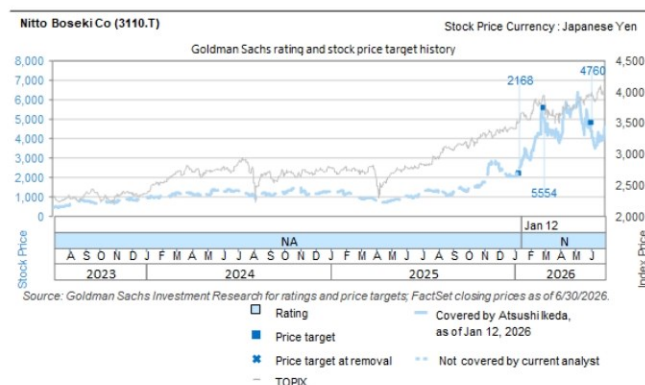
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Target price history table(s)

Mitsubishi Gas Chemical (4182.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
05-Jun-26	6,890	5,180
01-Mar-26	5,930	4,364
21-Nov-25	3,040	2,537
10-Oct-25	3,460	2,706
06-Jun-25	3,040	2,181
13-Feb-25	3,490	2,724
13-Nov-24	3,640	2,795
28-Aug-24	3,570	2,687
17-May-24	3,540	3,020
10-Apr-24	3,160	2,752
09-Feb-24	2,890	2,316
23-Nov-23	2,760	2,264
19-Oct-23	2,460	2,018

Resonac Holdings (4004.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
05-Jun-26	23,920	17,315
01-Mar-26	15,770	11,930
12-Jan-26	8,050	6,810

Mitsui Kinzoku Co. (5706.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
05-Jun-26	62,600	44,490
01-Mar-26	44,100	36,910
12-Jan-26	24,000	19,900

Nitto Boseki Co (3110.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
06-Jul-26	4,820	3,515
05-Jun-26	23,800	4,050
01-Mar-26	27,770	5,040
12-Jan-26	10,840	2,508

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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